
Placedon

Brand Philosophy & Content Direction

Spec date: 2026-08-16 · Derived from five-agent council review

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Derived from: Five-agent council (Brand Philosopher, CS/CA Buyer Voice, Devil's Advocate, Verbal Identity, GTM Reality Check)

What Placedon IS

Placedon is a **witness**, not a tool. It either has seen something in the statute or it hasn't. It testifies to what it has seen and refuses to testify to what it hasn't. That is not a feature — it is the category.

The product exists because of a specific failure mode in professional practice: **confident unverifiability**. Not ignorance. Practitioners are not ignorant. The risk is answers given in the language of authority without the substance of citation — answers that cannot be challenged because they sound right, and that carry professional liability when they're wrong. Placedon makes that gap visible.

The relationship between Placedon and its user is **division of epistemic labor**. The CS brings professional judgment, context, client relationship, interpretive experience accumulated over years. Placedon brings one thing: fidelity to what the statute literally says, and silence where it does not say. The CS decides. The witness says what it observed.

Core brand belief

The gap between sounds authoritative and is citable is where professional liability lives.

Every practising CS has given an answer at speed that was right enough but couldn't be survived in an adjudication hearing. Every compliance tool before Placedon treated that gap as acceptable. Placedon's existence is a claim that it is not.

The abstention — **ABSTAINS** when no citation exists — is not a limitation to be worked around. It is the product's most important output. **A known silence is safer than an unknown error.**

Verbal identity

Voice in three words

Terse. Traceable. Unsparing.

Filter test: would this sentence appear in a judgment? If it reads like advocacy or sales copy, cut it.

Rhythm rule

Claim, then evidence. Always split the assertion from its basis. Never merge them.

"The law doesn't need an opinion. It needs a citation." — two sentences where most brands write one. The break is not stylistic; it is structural. The second sentence is the proof of the first. This rule governs all Placedon copy.

Variation: a longer sentence is permitted only when it carries a necessary qualification. Never for rhythm, never for warmth. Paragraph length: two to four sentences. White space signals confidence.

Words IN

Word	Why
Provision	Statute has provisions, not rules or guidelines
Verified	Earned, binary, with a citation behind it
Section [number]	Always in monospace (s . 96), never paraphrased
Abstains	Used unashamedly — the product's most important word
Liability	The real word for what CS and CA professionals carry

Words OUT

Word	Why banned
Streamline	Implies friction was the problem — it wasn't
Empower	Placedon cites statute; empowerment is a promise the law never made
Solution	Implies a product category; Placedon is a reference instrument
Easy	Compliance is not easy; pretending otherwise destroys credibility
Smart	A modifier that signals insecurity; the work is verifiable, not clever

Register

Spectrum	Position	Reason
Formal ↔ Conversational	80% formal	The buyer uses formal register in their own work; matching it signals competency

Warm ↔ Cold	65% cold	Not hostile — indifferent to persuasion. Copy does not want to be liked; it wants to be trusted
Confident ↔ Humble	75% confident	Humility appears exactly once: in abstention. Citing statute is demonstration, not claim
Technical ↔ Plain	60% technical	CS professionals do not need a glossary; founders get plain language only where necessary

The governing paragraph (use as reference for all new copy)

Placedon covers the Companies Act, 2013. Every provision that drives the annual filing cycle — fully, with the amending instrument recorded where the Act was changed — or not at all. When it cannot point to the exact section behind an answer, it says so. That refusal is not a gap in coverage. It is the standard. The scope is narrow because the standard is not.

What the brand can honestly claim today

The GTM rule: **brand claims should always be one step behind the last provable artifact.**

Today's provable artifact is the architecture — the abstention-first design exists. The corpus does not yet exist. The claims follow accordingly.

Claim	Credible now	Notes
"The law doesn't need an opinion. It needs a citation."	Yes	Philosophy, not feature. Keep.
The architecture refuses to guess	Yes	Design property, verifiable
When it doesn't know, it says so	Yes	Design property
"~50 provisions covered"	No	Zero ingested yet — qualify as planned or remove
"Built for practising CS/CA"	No	Zero interviews done — soften to "practitioners who sign the filings"
"0% claims shipped unverified"	Only as design intent	Not a track record yet — say "designed so that"
"1,150+ ROC orders in FY 2024-25"	Use only for problem framing	Source unverified; do not use as product proof

The emotional core

The CS/CA buyer agent surfaced the line no compliance tool has ever said:

"We know that when this answer is wrong, it's your name on the order — not ours."

This is the emotional territory Placedon owns. Every piece of content should be grounded in the awareness that **this product was designed around the practitioner's liability, not the founder's convenience**. That is the asymmetry no competitor acknowledges.

Landing page changes that follow from this spec

Cut / replace

Current	Problem	Replacement direction
"Statutory compliance, verified" (tagline)	"Verified by whom?" — no answer	"Every answer traced to the exact section." Mechanistic, falsifiable, auditable
"~50 provisions covered — every compliance-relevant section"	Zero ingested, "every" is overclaim	Remove or qualify as "planned coverage" until first provisions are live
"Built for practising Company Secretaries and CAs"	Zero interviews — dangerous overclaim	"Designed for practitioners who sign the filings"
Waitlist framing	Implies late-beta product; misleads CS audience	Early-access research program: "Ten practitioners. You shape what gets built. First access."

Add

Addition	Rationale
Corpus date / amendment lineage transparency	The CS buyer's first question: "As of what date? Which amendment?"
One real verified answer (when first provision is live)	The only thing that converts a CS: "Show me s.96(1) and let me check it myself in three minutes."
Explicit scope statement — what is NOT covered	Devil's Advocate: saying what you won't do is a stronger trust signal than what you will

Do not change

Element	Why
"The law doesn't need an opinion. It needs a citation."	Lands with CS audience, credible on day zero
"We don't guess."	Philosophy claim, correct and defensible
"Slow / Blind / Confident" gap grid	Problem framing is right regardless of statute
Design system (colors, type, spacing)	Quiet authority is correct for this audience

The waitlist reframe

Current: *"Join the waitlist"*

Honest reframe: Placedon has no corpus yet and zero CS interviews done. A waitlist implies imminent delivery. The honest ask is:

"We're talking to ten practising Company Secretaries before we ingest a single provision. If you help shape what gets built, you get first access."

This treats the CS as the authority they are. It's also how the business plan describes the actual next step — ten conversations before any corpus spend.

First proof artifact (when ready)

Before any brand claim about coverage, publish one public verification log:

- Take `s.96(1)` of the Companies Act
- Ingest via `ingest_companies_act.py`, byte-verified against India Code
- Run `check_transcription.py`
- Post the diff publicly

A CS who sees that understands immediately what abstention-first means in practice. It is more credible than any landing page copy.

What is NOT being decided here

- The product roadmap (covered in `TECHNICAL_PLAN.md`)
- Whether to add a second statute (`BUSINESS_PLAN.md` §5 — no, until Companies Act has paying users)
- Pricing or unit economics
- Visual design changes beyond copy

This spec governs: what the brand believes, how it sounds, what it can honestly say, and what content direction the website follows from that.